

14. Which of the following is not a coalfield of Germany?

- (a) Ruhr Valley
- (b) Lorraine Basin
- (c) Saar Basin
- (d) Achen Basin
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2020

Ans. (b)

Lorraine is a cultural and historical region in northeastern France (mainly). Rest of the coalfields - Ruhr Valley, Saar Basin and Achen Basin are in Germany.

15. With reference to "Kuzbass region in Russia", which of the following statement/s is/are correct?

1. This region is rich in coal and iron ore.
2. Novosibirsk is an important industrial center of this region.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

Code :

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 2
- (c) Both 1 and 2
- (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

The Kuzbass region in Russia is mainly famous for coal production. The region exports approximately 1200 types of industrial products coal, coke, rolled steel, cast-iron, aluminium, zinc, ferroalloys etc.

The Kemerovo region is located in the southeast of western Siberia. It borders the regions of Khakassia, Altai republics, the Altai as well as the Krasnoyarsk, Tomsk and Novosibirsk regions.

ii. The Iron Ore

*The most abundant metal found in Earth's core is iron. It is found along with Aluminium, Lime, Magnesia, Soapstone, Titanium, Arsenic, Copper, Phosphorus and other minerals. With the Industrial Revolution picking up pace the extraction of Iron also gained momentum. *According to World Mineral Production, 2018-22, the top five leading producers of iron ore in the world (in the year 2022) are –1. Australia (944.05 million metric tonnes), 2. Brazil (403.02 million metric tonnes), 3. China (260.00 million metric tonnes), 4. India (252.31 million metric tonnes), 5. Iran (105.00 million metric tonnes). *According to the USGS Mineral Commodity Summaries, 2025 top five leading countries in the world in terms of iron content reserves are –(1) Australia (2) Brazil (3) Russia (4) China (5) India. *The Krivoy Rog region

of Ukraine and Magnitogorsk in Russia are famous for iron ore production. *The Pilbara region and Hamersley mine area of Australia are famous for iron ore extraction. *In USA large scale production of iron ore is done in Minnesota and Michigan.

1. Which one is the second largest metal present in the earth's womb?

- (a) Iron
- (b) Aluminium
- (c) Copper
- (d) Zinc

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (b)

Iron is the most commonly found metal in the Earth's womb. After this, nickel and aluminium are found respectively. The most commonly found metal in the Earth's crust is aluminium and after that the second metal is iron. Since nickel is the second most commonly found metal in the Earth's womb, aluminium would be the desired answer as there is no nickel in the question.

2. Identify the correct sequence of the iron ore producing countries of the world in their descending order :

- (a) Australia, China, Brazil, Sweden
- (b) Brazil, Sweden, Australia, China
- (c) China, Brazil, Sweden, Australia
- (d) China, Brazil, Australia, Sweden

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2008

Ans. (d)

The correct descending order of Iron-producing countries, in the year 2008 when the question was asked, was China, Brazil, Australia and Sweden. Presently, according to World Mineral Production 2018-22, the descending order of iron ore producing countries (in the year, 2022) is as follows– Australia > Brazil > China > India.

3. Which one of the following is the largest producer of Iron ore in the world ?

- (a) China
- (b) India
- (c) Brazil
- (d) France

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (a)

China was the largest producer of Iron ore in the world during the question period. Presently, Australia is the largest (2022) producer of Iron ore in the world.

4. 'Marquette range' in United States of America is famous for which mineral?

- (a) Uranium
- (b) Copper
- (c) Zinc
- (d) Iron ore

M.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

The 'Marquette range' in the United States of America is famous for iron ore minerals. The Marquette Iron range is located in Marquette County of Michigan in the United States of America. Hence option (d) is the correct answer.

5. The first position in the production of Iron ore is of –

- (a) Philippines (b) America
(c) Russia (d) India

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1991

Ans. (d)

The largest producers of Iron Ore are Australia, Brazil, China, and India respectively (World Mineral Production, 2018-22). As they are not given in the options, India is the correct answer.

6. Among the iron-producing countries of Europe, France stands

- (a) First (b) Second
(c) Third (d) Fourth

U.P. U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2010, 2013

Ans. (*)

According to data for the year 2013, Russia, Ukraine and Sweden are the main iron ore producing countries of Europe. France is not included in these four but data for the year 2013 shows that France is in the fifth position in the production of Pig Iron, subsequent to Russia, Ukraine, Germany and Turkiye. So none of the above will be correct answer. According to the data for the year 2022, Russia, Ukraine and Sweden are the three largest iron ore producing countries of Europe.

7. Match List-I with List-II and choose the correct answer using the codes given below:

List – I (Iron ore region)	List-II (Concerned Country)
A. Lorraine	1. Sweden
B. Midland	2. Kazakhstan
C. Kiruna	3. U.K
D. Kostanay	4. France

Code :

A	B	C	D
(a) 4	2	3	1
(b) 3	4	2	1
(c) 4	3	1	2
(d) 1	2	3	4

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Spl) (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

The correct match of List-I with List-II is as follows :

Iron Ore region	Producer Country
Lorraine	– France
Midland	– U.K
Kiruna	– Sweden
Kostanay	– Kazakhstan

8. Assertion (A) :

Rich placer deposits of gold are found on the Ghana coast and gold-bearing veins are found in Brazil.

Reason (R) :

At some point of time, these continents were joined together along the Atlantic coast.

Select the correct answer.

- (a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A
(c) A is false but R is true
(d) A is true but R is false

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre), 2023

Ans. (b)

It is remarkable that there are abundant placer gold deposits along Ghana's coast yet there is not a single rock source in the area. Significantly, when the two continents were side by side it was obvious that Ghana's gold reserves originated from the Brazil plateau because of the gold bearing veins located there. Hence Assertion (A) is right, but Reason (R) is not right. It is worth mentioning that, one of the earliest hypotheses on how continents moved throughout time was described by the 'Continental Drift theory'. On this map, Gondwana, an early 'Supercontinent' is depicted. Gondwana gradually shifted to make way for the current continents.

9. Which one of the following is NOT correctly matching?

(Country)	(Iron-Ore Producing Area)
(a) Kazakhstan	- Karaganda
(b) Ukraine	- Krivoy Rog
(c) Germany	- Normandy
(d) France	- Pyrenees

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2016

Ans. (c)

Correct match are as follows :

(Country)	(Iron-Ore Producing Area)
Kazakhstan	- Karaganda
Ukraine	- Krivoy Rog
France	- Normandy
France	- Pyrenees

10. The Lorraine Region of France is famous for :

- (a) Chemical industry
(b) Iron and Steel industry